

in the field. Some sections need rules, some do not and these are already enforced. But many sections do need rules. There would be 45 days for all the stakeholders to give their comments. We will go through these comments and finally finalise the rules. The second part is capacity building of our enforcement machinery, both at the central and state levels, of the trade unions so that workers know what the Codes have specifically enhanced for them and capacity building also of the industry, especially MSMEs.

28 | The third part is the IT enablement of the various processes. The registration, licences, returns, everything is through an online system. Even the inspections have to be web-based and randomised, so that there is no discretion with the enforcement machinery. All these processes have to be now fully digitised. We are doing that at the central level, and we also discussed with the states to modify their systems so that they are ready for the digital transformation.

There is also a fourth component. We are

working on certain handbooks, especially for industry and MSMEs, for compliance. We have also prepared certain checklists and shared it with the states because there is a sequence of actions that need to be taken, whether it is rules, notifications, regulations, the governance system, the boards have to be put in place, the funds have to be set up.

We will soon have regional meetings and conferences with the states so that we can continue to discuss these and if there is any area in which they require any legal clarification or technical assistance, we will be there to support them.

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What is the effective date for the Codes to become fully applicable?

Legally, the Codes become fully effective when all the rules are ready. However, the digitisation part is very important and is happening simultaneously. We are working to ensure that both the finalisation of rules and the modification of our digital systems and the state system happen in sync and simultane-



ously, so that those benefits can flow. Instead of looking at a date driven approach, we are looking at a systematic approach.

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The reforms are expected to boost investments by improving the ease of doing business. What are your thoughts on this?

You are spot on that this will bring a very

predictable and efficient and transparent system for industries. That should boost investor confidence and enhance trust in the system. Provisions on decriminalisation, features like fixed-term employment (FTE) and flexible working hours will also help industry tailor their actual employment or the number of people or hours based on the

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